



FREE SAMPLE

CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 Exam Practice Questions

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10 of 611 questions

Questions With Answers & Explanations

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Question #1

Which of the following threat actors is the most likely to be hired by a foreign government to attack critical systems located in other countries?

- A. Hacktivist
- B. Whistleblower
- C. Organized crime
- D. Unskilled attacker

✓ Correct Answer: C — Organized crime

Organized crime groups have the resources, capability, and profit motive to be hired by foreign governments for sophisticated cyberattacks on critical infrastructure. They operate as professional entities with established business relationships and can be contracted for high-value operations. Hacktivists are ideologically motivated rather than mercenary, whistleblowers leak information rather than attack systems, and unskilled attackers lack the sophistication required for critical infrastructure targeting.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A. Hacktivists are ideologically motivated, not hired for profit by governments.
- B. Whistleblowers disclose information rather than conduct attacks.
- D. Unskilled attackers lack the sophistication to target critical systems effectively.

Question #2

Which of the following is used to add extra complexity before using a one-way data transformation algorithm?

- A. Key stretching
- B. Data masking
- C. Steganography
- D. Salting

✓ Correct Answer: D — Salting

Salting adds random data to input before applying a one-way hash function, increasing complexity and preventing rainbow table attacks. It is specifically designed to add extra complexity before hashing. Key stretching is a related but distinct technique that applies hashing multiple times, data masking obscures sensitive data visibility, and steganography hides information within other media.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A. Key stretching applies the algorithm repeatedly, not adding complexity before transformation.

- B. Data masking obscures data visibility rather than adding cryptographic complexity.
- C. Steganography hides information within media, unrelated to hash algorithms.

Question #3

An employee clicked a link in an email from a payment website that asked the employee to update contact information. The employee entered the log-in information but received a “page not found” error message.

Which of the following types of social engineering attacks occurred?

- A. Brand impersonation
- B. Pretexting
- C. Typosquatting
- D. Phishing

Correct Answer: D — Phishing

This scenario describes a classic phishing attack where an employee received a deceptive email from what appeared to be a payment website, clicked a link, and entered credentials on a fraudulent page. The 'page not found' error is typical when the phishing site has captured the credentials. Brand impersonation is the technique used but phishing is the attack type; pretexting involves creating false scenarios verbally; typosquatting involves domain name mimicry.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A. Brand impersonation is the technique used within the phishing attack, not the attack type itself.
- B. Pretexting typically involves direct communication and building false relationships, not fake websites.
- C. Typosquatting involves slightly misspelled domain names, not exact impersonation in emails.

Question #4

An enterprise is trying to limit outbound DNS traffic originating from its internal network. Outbound DNS requests will only be allowed from one device with the IP address 10.50.10.25.

Which of the following firewall ACLs will accomplish this goal?

- A. Access list outbound permit 0.0.0.0/0 0.0.0.0/0 port 53 Access list outbound deny 10.50.10.25/32 0.0.0.0/0 port 53
- B. Access list outbound permit 0.0.0.0/0 10.50.10.25/32 port 53 Access list outbound deny 0.0.0.0/0 0.0.0.0/0 port 53

- C. Access list outbound permit 0.0.0.0/0 0.0.0.0/0 port 53 Access list outbound deny 0.0.0.0/0 10.50.10.25/32 port 53
- D. Access list outbound permit 10.50.10.25/32 0.0.0.0/0 port 53 Access list outbound deny 0.0.0.0/0 0.0.0.0/0 port 53

✓ **Correct Answer: D — Access list outbound permit 10.50.10.25/32 0.0.0.0/0 port 53 Access list outbound deny 0.0.0.0/0 0.0.0.0/0 port 53**

ACLs are processed top-to-bottom with first match wins. Option D permits DNS traffic only from 10.50.10.25 to any destination on port 53, then denies all other outbound DNS traffic. This correctly restricts DNS to the single authorized device. Options A and C deny the authorized device or permit then deny the same traffic illogically. Option B reverses source/destination incorrectly.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A. This denies the authorized device (10.50.10.25) after permitting all others, opposite of the requirement.
- B. This reverses source and destination in the first line, allowing all devices to send to 10.50.10.25.
- C. This permits all outbound DNS first, making the second deny statement unreachable.

Question #5

A data administrator is configuring authentication for a SaaS application and would like to reduce the number of credentials employees need to maintain. The company prefers to use domain credentials to access new SaaS applications.

Which of the following methods would allow this functionality?

- A. SSO
- B. LEAP
- C. MFA
- D. PEAP

✓ **Correct Answer: A — SSO**

Single Sign-On (SSO) allows employees to use a single set of credentials (domain credentials) to authenticate to multiple applications, eliminating the need to maintain separate credentials for each SaaS application. LEAP and PEAP are wireless authentication protocols, not identity management solutions; MFA adds authentication factors but doesn't reduce credential management.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- B. LEAP is a wireless authentication protocol, not applicable to SaaS credential management.

- C. MFA adds authentication factors but doesn't reduce the number of credential sets required.
- D. PEAP is a wireless authentication protocol, not a SaaS credential management solution.

Question #6

Which of the following scenarios describes a possible business email compromise attack?

- A. An employee receives a gift card request in an email that has an executive's name in the display field of the email.
- B. Employees who open an email attachment receive messages demanding payment in order to access files.
- C. A service desk employee receives an email from the HR director asking for log-in credentials to a cloud administrator account.
- D. An employee receives an email with a link to a phishing site that is designed to look like the company's email portal.

✓ **Correct Answer: C — A service desk employee receives an email from the HR director asking for log-in credentials to a cloud administrator account.**

Business Email Compromise (BEC) attacks target employees with authority or access by impersonating executives or trusted contacts to request sensitive actions. Option C describes a classic BEC scenario where someone impersonating an HR director requests cloud administrator credentials from a service desk employee. Option A is gift card phishing, option B is ransomware, and option D is standard phishing to the email portal.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A. Gift card requests represent basic phishing, not the sophisticated impersonation characteristic of BEC.
- B. Email attachments causing ransomware describes malware delivery, not BEC social engineering.
- D. Phishing links to company portals are standard phishing, not the account compromise targeting of BEC.

Question #7

A company prevented direct access from the database administrators' workstations to the network segment that contains database servers.

Which of the following should a database administrator use to access the database servers?

- A. Jump server
- B. RADIUS
- C. HSM
- D. Load balancer

✓ **Correct Answer: A — Jump server**

A jump server (bastion host) is a hardened, monitored intermediary system that allows administrators to access restricted network segments without direct connectivity. It enforces access control and logging for administrative activities. RADIUS is an authentication protocol, HSM is for key management, and load balancers distribute traffic, none addressing the access restriction requirement.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- B.** RADIUS is an authentication protocol, not a mechanism for accessing restricted network segments.
- C.** HSM (Hardware Security Module) manages cryptographic keys, not administrative access routing.
- D.** Load balancers distribute network traffic, not provide restricted access for administrators.

Question #8

An organization's internet-facing website was compromised when an attacker exploited a buffer overflow.

Which of the following should the organization deploy to best protect against similar attacks in the future?

- A. NGFW
- B. WAF
- C. TLS
- D. SD-WAN

✓ **Correct Answer: B — WAF**

A Web Application Firewall (WAF) is specifically designed to protect web applications by analyzing HTTP/HTTPS traffic and detecting/blocking attacks like buffer overflows, SQL injection, and XSS at the application layer. NGFW operates at network layer, TLS provides encryption, and SD-WAN manages network connectivity; none specifically protect against application-level exploits.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A.** NGFW protects at the network layer and cannot detect application-level buffer overflow exploits.

- C. TLS provides encryption in transit but cannot prevent buffer overflow exploitation.
- D. SD-WAN manages network routing and connectivity, not application security threats.

Question #9

An administrator notices that several users are logging in from suspicious IP addresses. After speaking with the users, the administrator determines that the employees were not logging in from those IP addresses and resets the affected users' passwords.

Which of the following should the administrator implement to prevent this type of attack from succeeding in the future?

- A. Multifactor authentication
- B. Permissions assignment
- C. Access management
- D. Password complexity

✓ Correct Answer: A — Multifactor authentication

Multifactor authentication (MFA) would prevent unauthorized access even if credentials are compromised, since attackers would need a second authentication factor (such as a code from the user's phone) that only the legitimate user possesses. This directly addresses the scenario where passwords were stolen and used from suspicious locations.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- B. Permissions assignment controls what authenticated users can do, not who can authenticate.
- C. Access management is too broad and doesn't specifically prevent credential-based attacks.
- D. Password complexity alone doesn't prevent compromised passwords from being used by attackers.

Question #10

An employee receives a text message that appears to have been sent by the payroll department and is asking for credential verification.

Which of the following social engineering techniques are being attempted? (Choose two.)

- A. Typosquatting
- B. Phishing
- C. Impersonation
- D. Vishing

- E. Smishing
- F. Misinformation

✓ **Correct Answer: C, E**

C. Impersonation

E. Smishing

Impersonation (C) is occurring because someone is pretending to be the payroll department, and smishing (E) is the specific technique of conducting phishing attacks via SMS text messages. These two elements combine to describe this attack scenario.

Why The Other Options Are Incorrect

- A.** Typosquatting involves creating fake websites with similar URLs, not text message impersonation.
- B.** Phishing is the broader category, but smishing is the specific technique used for text-based phishing.
- D.** Vishing is voice-based phishing, not text message-based.
- F.** Misinformation spreads false information, but this attack is specifically attempting credential theft through impersonation.



That was the sample.

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